

Program: Diploma in Microelectronics	
Course Code: 6491C	Course Title: RF MEMS
Semester: 6	Credits: 4
Course Category: Program Elective	
Periods per week: 4 (L:4, T:0, P:0)	Periods per semester: 60

Course Objectives:

- To understand the principle of operation of MEMS switches
- To know the operation of micromachined inductors and capacitors
- To understand the operation of micromachined RF filters and phase shifters
- To get an awareness on micromachined antenna and packaging for RF MEMS

Course Prerequisites:

Topic	Course code	Course Title	Semester
Electronic components		Fundamentals of Electrical and Electronics Engineering	2
Microsensor, microactuator, micromachining, micro system packaging		Introduction to MEMS	4

Course Outcomes:

On completion of the course, the student will be able to:

COn	Description	Duration (Hours)	Cognitive level
CO1	Explain the principle of operation of MEMS switches	15	Understanding
CO2	Understand the principle of operation of micromachined inductors and capacitors	14	Understanding
CO3	Understand the principle of operation of micromachined RF filters and phase shifters	15	Understanding
CO4	Explain the fundamentals of micromachined antenna and packaging for RF MEMS	14	Understanding
	Series Test	2	

CO-PO Mapping:

Course Outcomes	PO1	PO2	PO3	PO4	PO5	PO6	PO7
CO1	3	3					
CO2	3	3					
CO3	3	3					
CO4	3	3					

3-Strongly mapped, 2-Moderately mapped, 1-Weakly mapped

Course Outline:

Module Outcomes	Description	Duration (Hours)	Cognitive Level
CO1	Explain the principle of operation of MEMS switches		
M1.01	Discuss the basics of switching	4	Understanding
M1.02	Explain the switches for RF and microwave applications	5	Understanding
M1.03	Describe the actuation mechanisms for MEMS devices	4	Understanding
M1.04	Understand the working of bistable micro relays	2	Understanding
Contents: RF MEMS switches and micro relays (Basic theory only) Introduction, Switch parameters, Basics of switching - Mechanical switches, Electronic switches, Switches for RF and microwave applications - Mechanical RF switches, PIN diode RF switches, Metal oxide semiconductor field effect transistors and monolithic microwave integrated circuits, RF MEMS switches, Actuation mechanisms for MEMS devices - Electrostatic switching, Mercury contact switches, Electromagnetic switching, Thermal switching, Bistable micro relays			
CO2	Understand the principle of operation of micromachined inductors and capacitors		
M2.01	Discuss the basics of MEMS/micromachined passive elements	2	Understanding
M2.02	Explain various MEMS inductors	7	Understanding
M2.03	Understand the operation of MEMS capacitors	5	Understanding
	Series Test - I	1	

Contents:**MEMS inductors and capacitors (Basic theory only)**

Introduction, MEMS/micromachined passive elements: pros and cons, MEMS inductors - Self-inductance and mutual inductance, Micromachined inductors, Folded inductors, Variable inductors, Polymer-based inductors

MEMS capacitors - MEMS gap-tuning capacitors, MEMS area-tuning capacitors, Dielectric tunable capacitors.

CO3	Understand the principle of operation of micromachined RF filters and phase shifters		
M3.01	Discuss various micromechanical filters	4	Understanding
M3.02	Understand the basics of surface acoustic wave filters	4	Understanding
M3.03	Describe the operation of MEMS phase shifters	4	Understanding
M3.04	Discuss the working of ferroelectric phase shifters	3	Understanding

Contents:**Micromachined RF filters and phase shifters (No design required)**

Micromechanical filters - Electrostatic comb drive, Micromechanical filters using comb drives, Micromechanical filters using electrostatic coupled beam structures

Surface acoustic wave filters - Basics of surface acoustic wave filter operation, Surface acoustic wave devices: capabilities, limitations and applications, Bulk acoustic wave filters, Micromachined filters for millimeter wave frequencies

Phase shifters - Types of phase shifters and their limitations

MEMS phase shifters - Switched delay line phase shifters, Distributed MEMS phase shifters, Polymer-based phase shifters

Ferroelectric phase shifters - Distributed parallel plate capacitors, Bilateral interdigital phase shifters, Interdigital capacitor phase shifters

CO4	Explain the fundamentals of micromachined antenna and packaging for RF MEMS		
M4.01	Discuss the fundamentals of micromachined antenna	6	Understanding
M4.02	Explain the packaging for RF MEMS	4	Understanding
M4.03	Understand the reliability issues in packaging	4	Understanding

	Series Test - I	1	
Contents: Micromachined antennae (Basic theory only) Overview of microstrip antennae - Basic characteristics of microstrip antennae, Micromachining techniques to improve antenna performance, Micromachining as a fabrication process for small antennae - Horn antenna for W-band, Tapered slot antenna Micromachined reconfigurable antennae - Vee antenna Packaging for RF MEMS devices and Reliability Issues Role of MEMS packages - Mechanical support, Electrical interface, Protection from the environment, Thermal considerations Types of MEMS packages - Metal, Ceramic, Plastic, Multilayer, Embedded overlay, Wafer-level, Microshielding and self-packaging RF MEMS Packaging : Reliability issues - Packaging materials, Integration of MEMS devices with microelectronics, Wiring and interconnections, Reliability and key failure mechanisms			

Text /Reference:

T/R	Book Title/Author
T1	Vijay Varadan, K. J. Vinoy, K. A. Jose, “RF MEMS and Their Applications”, Wiley, 2003
R1	Gabriel M. Rebeiz, “RF MEMS: Theory, Design, and Technology”, Wiley, 2003
R2	Hector J. De Los Santos, “RF MEMS Circuit Design for Wireless Applications”, Artech House, 2002
R3	Eun Sok kim “Fundamentals of Micro electro mechanical Systems (MEMS)” McGraw Hill

Online resources:

Sl. No.	Website Link
1	https://omidi.iut.ac.ir/SDR/2008/Projects/Fereydani_SDR_project/References/%5B5%5D%20RF%20MEMS%20And%20Their%20Applications.pdf
2	https://resources.pcb.cadence.com/blog/2023-rf-mems-micro-electro-mechanical-systems-introduction
3	https://www.analog.com/en/product-category/mems-switches.html#category-detail
4	https://www.everythingrf.com/community/what-are-rf-mems